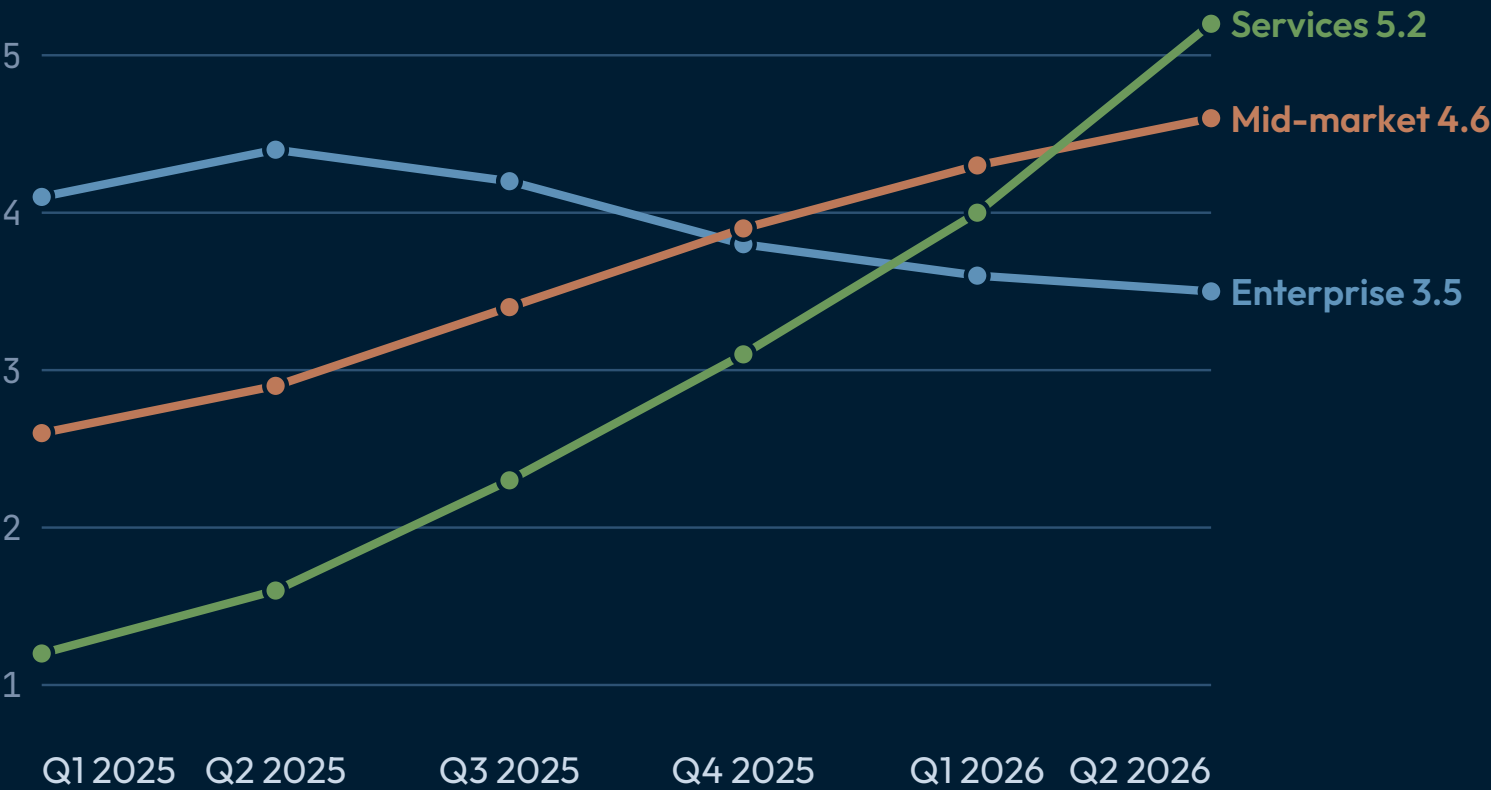


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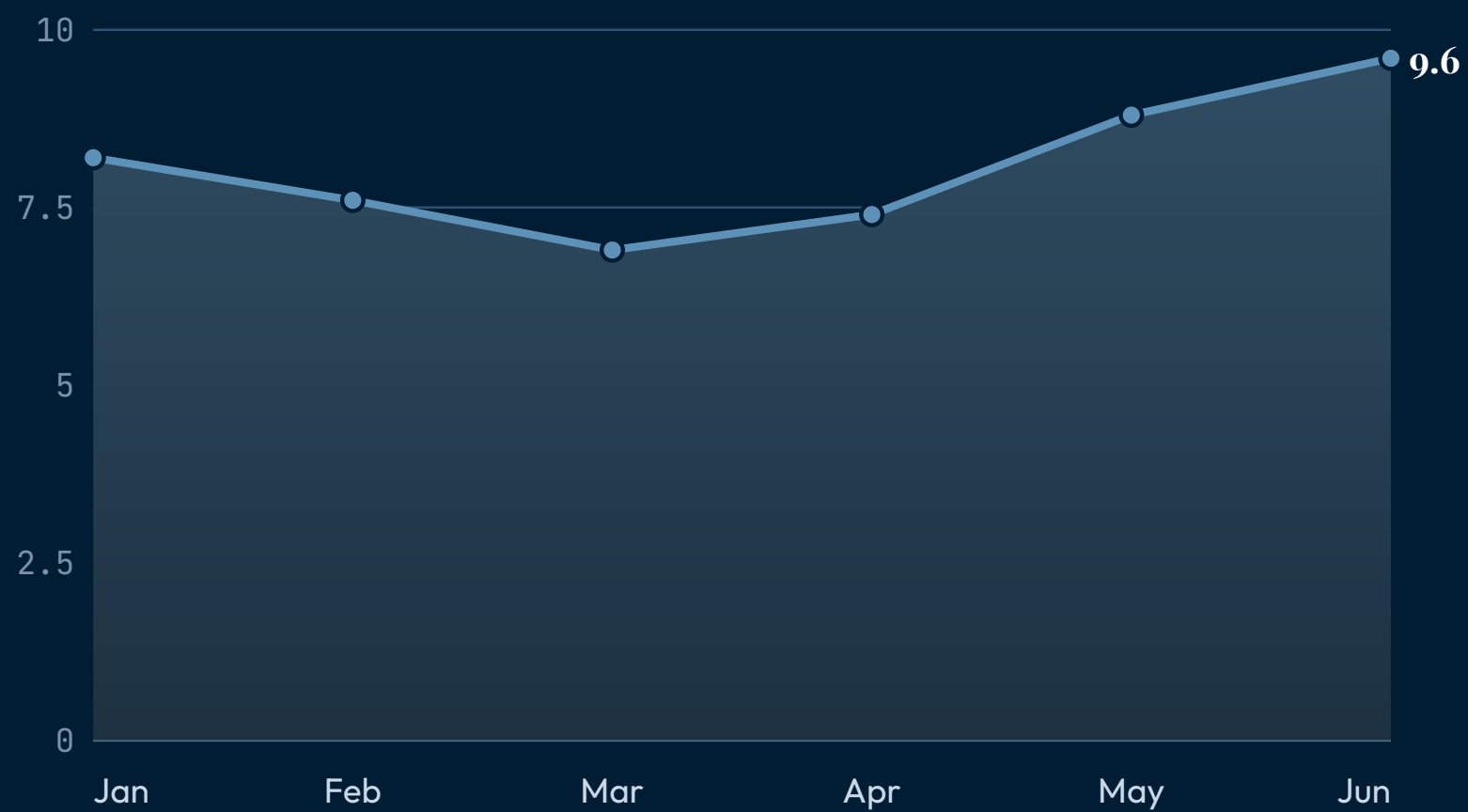
# line

A measure plotted across an ordered axis, so the movement is the read — one line or several, optionally filled, stacked, or stepped.

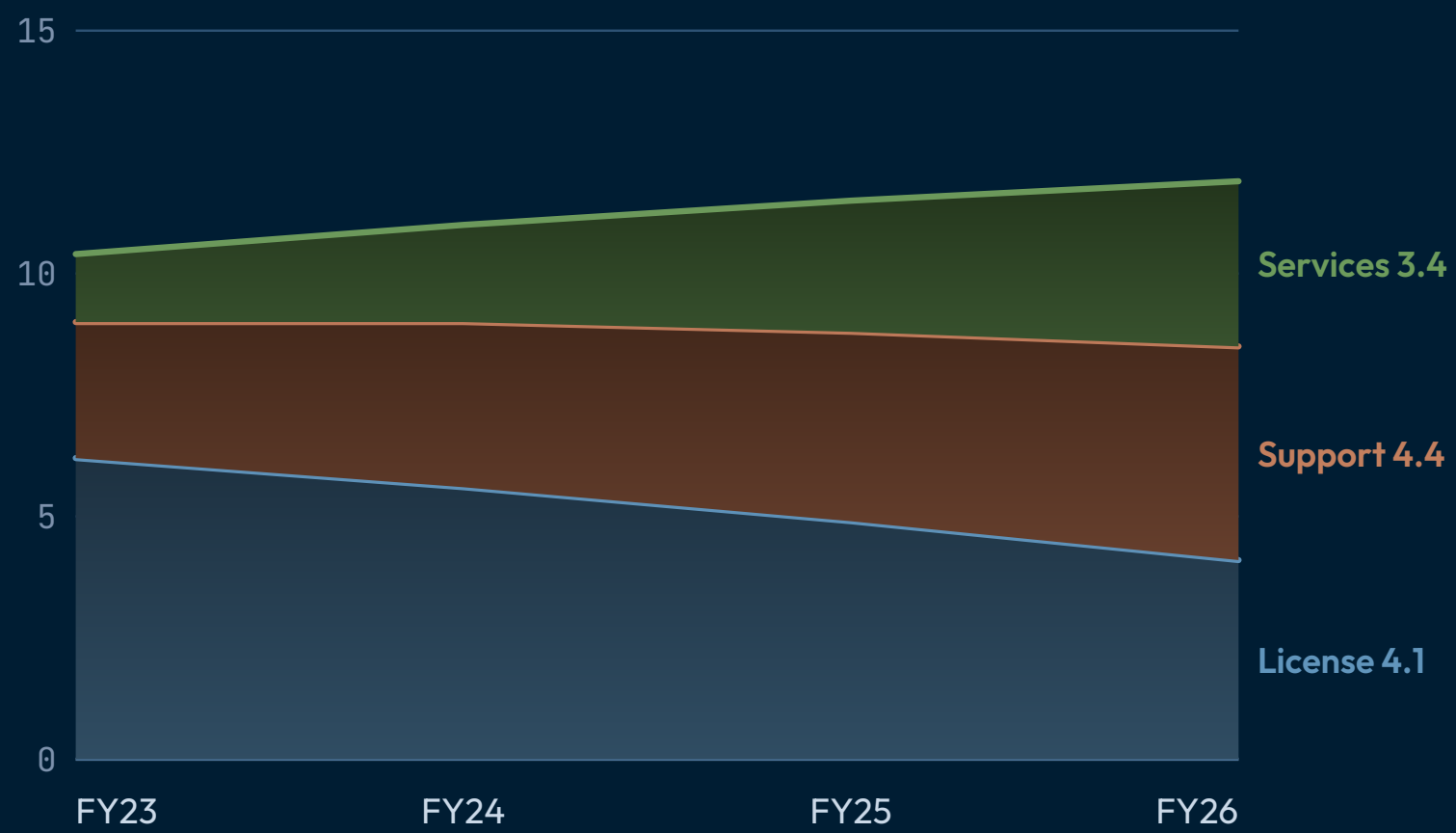
# Services grew into the gap enterprise left.



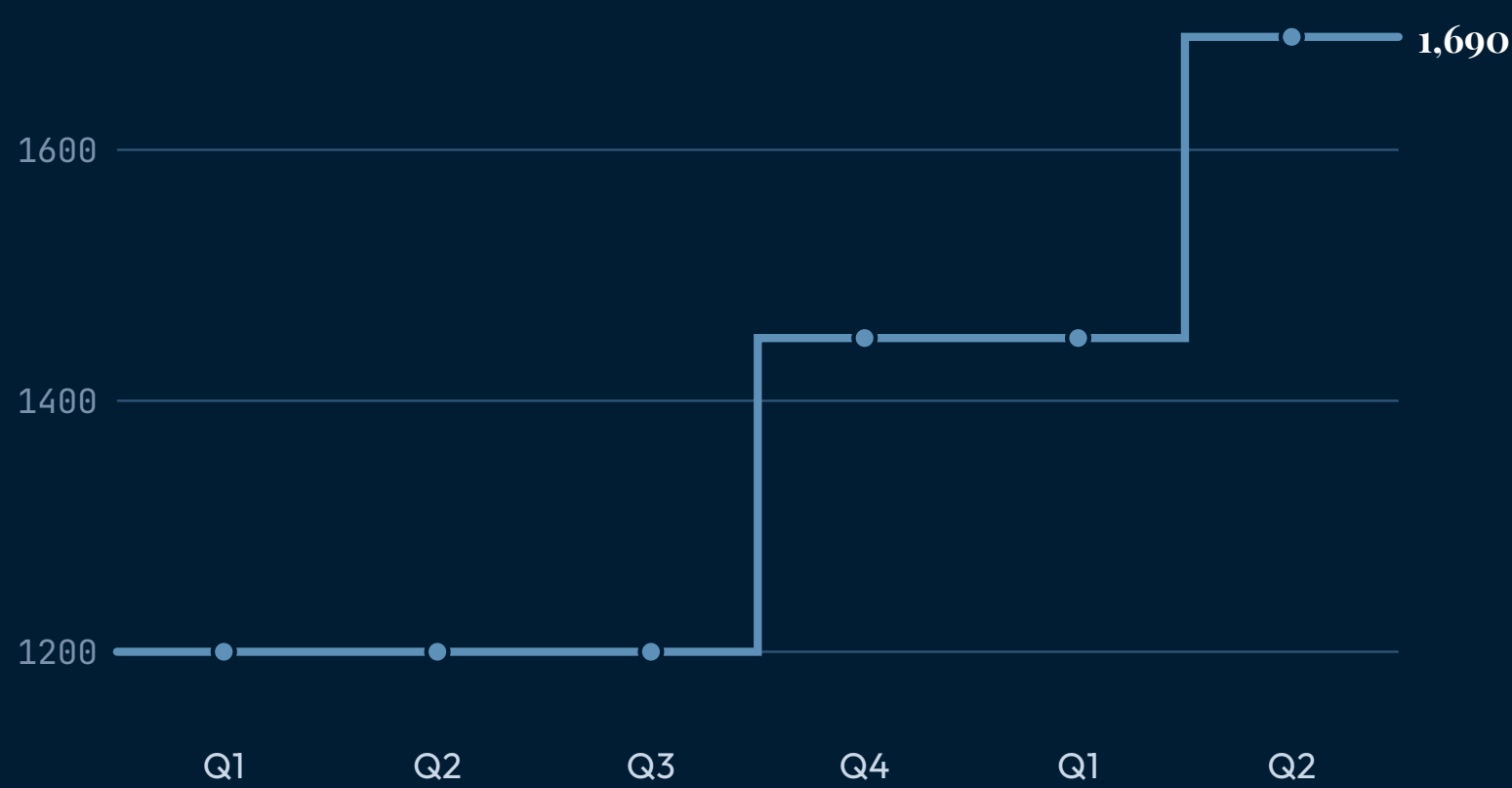
# Cash on hand never dipped below one quarter of runway.



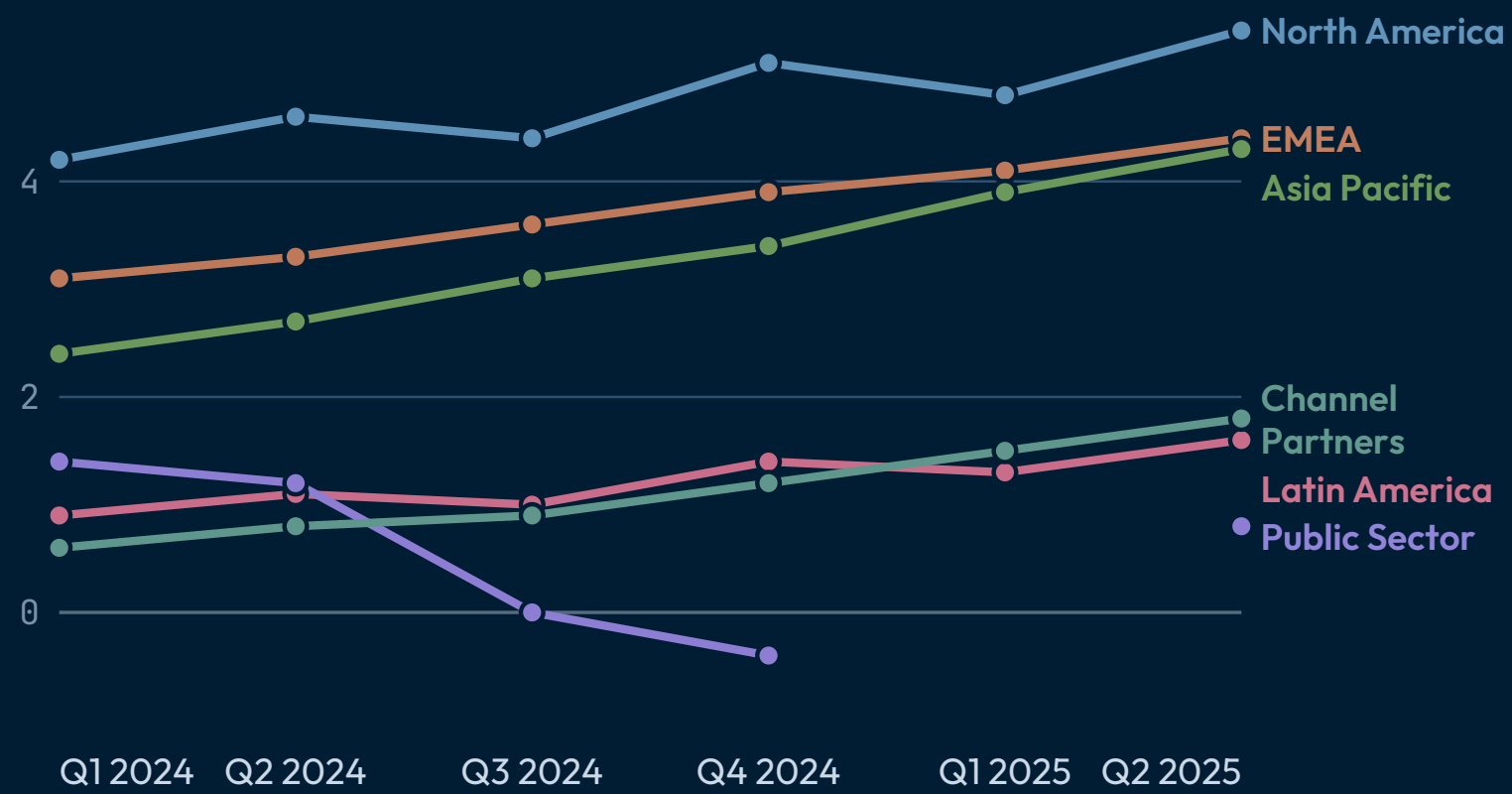
# The mix shifted; the total barely moved.



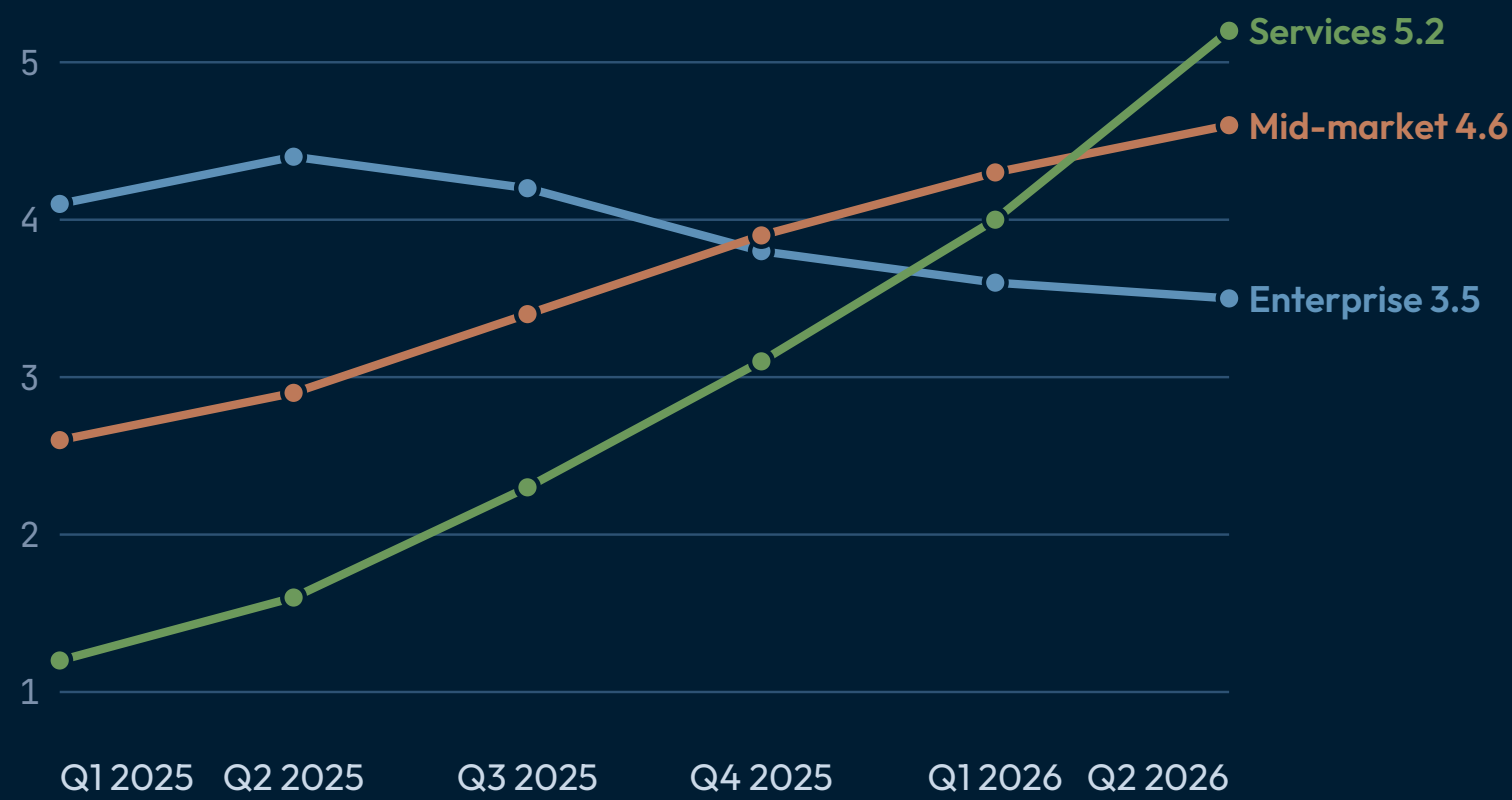
# The list price held for three quarters, then moved twice.



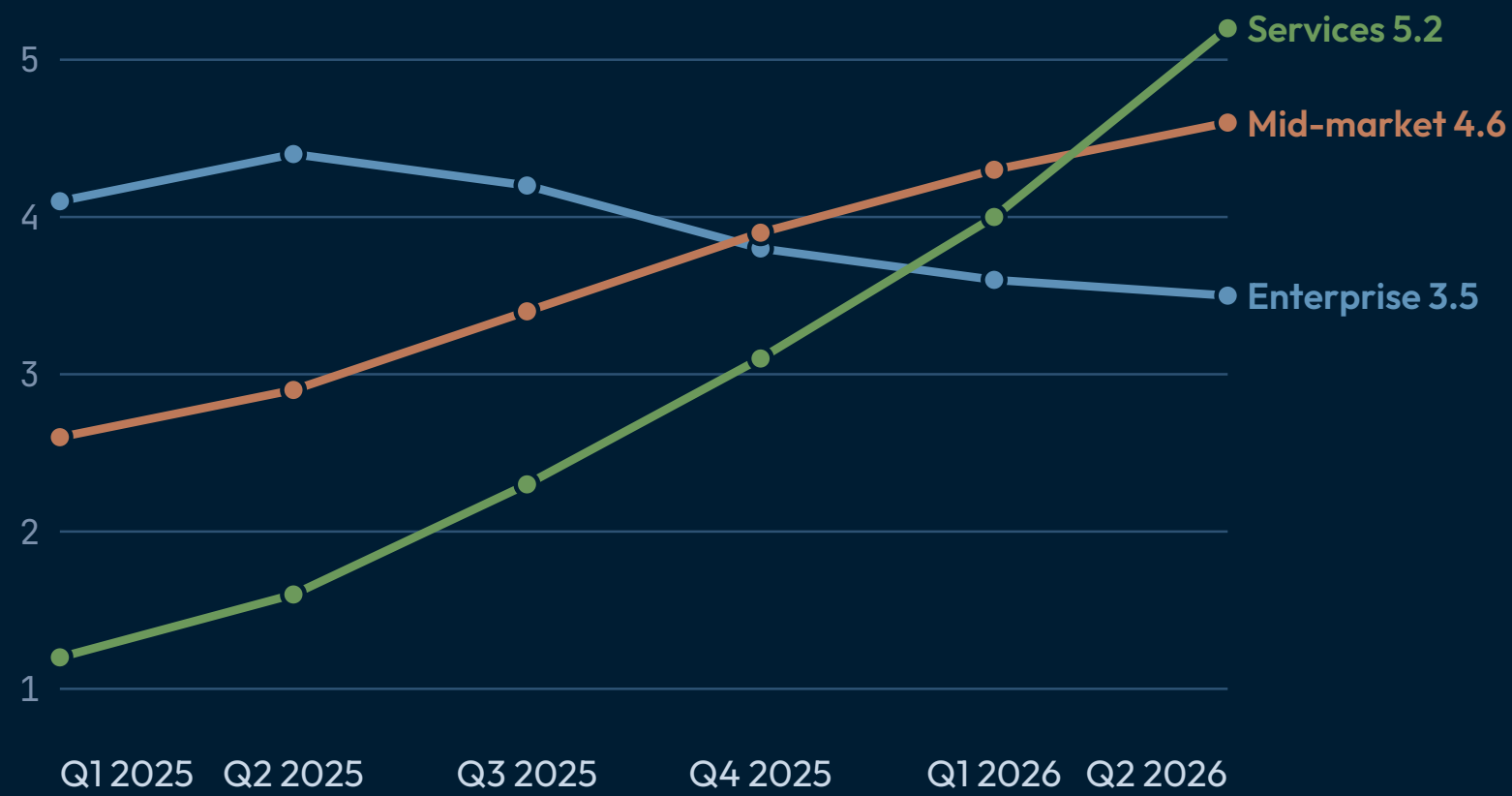
# Six lines, six quarters, one hole and one loss.



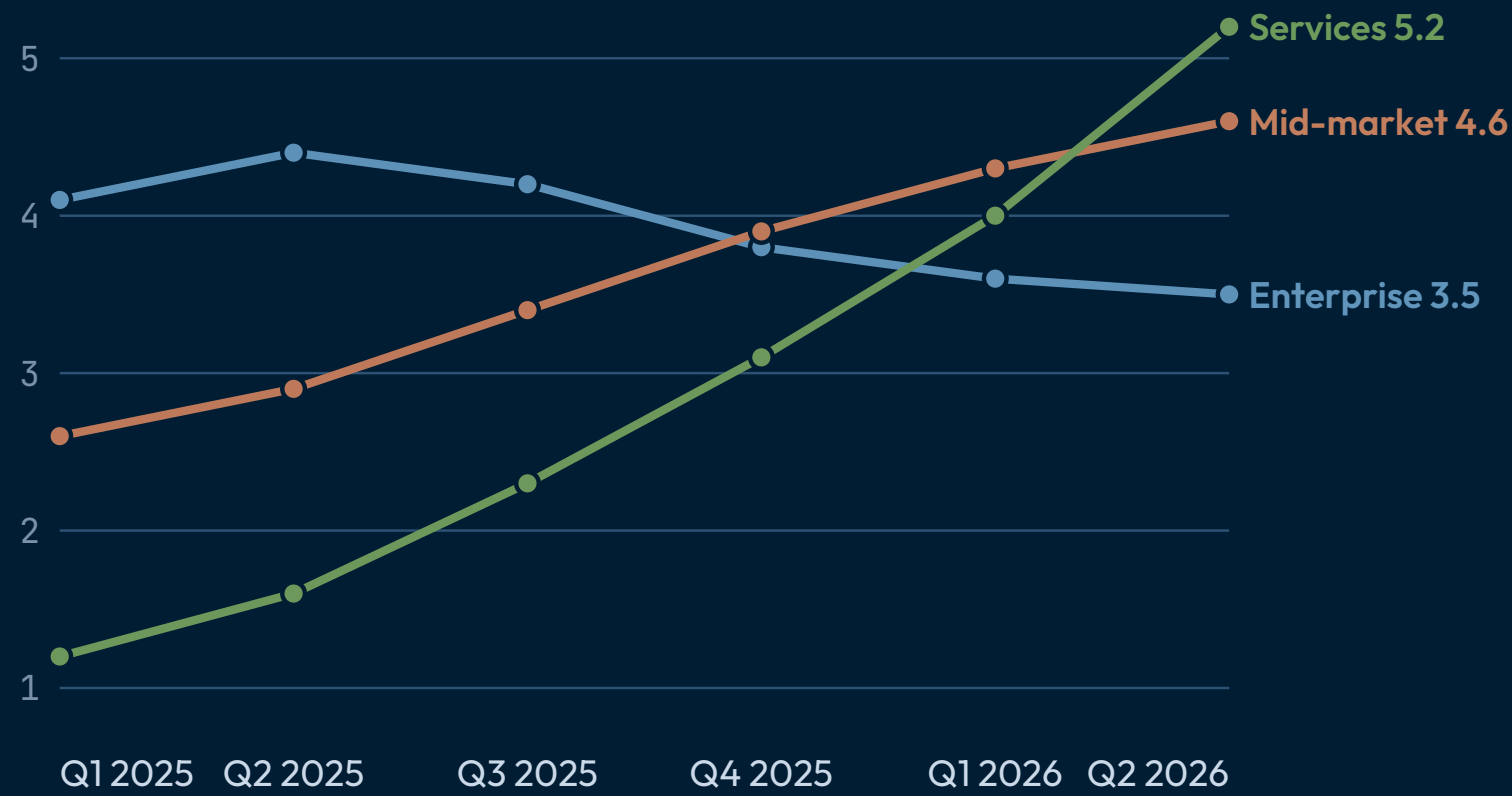
# Services grew into the gap enterprise left.



# Services grew into the gap enterprise left.



# Services grew into the gap enterprise left.



# When NOT to reach for line.

## Two points

Two points are a slope, and `slope` draws it better. Note it is authored transposed: one bullet per entity, its two points nested.

## Categories that are not ordered

Joining 'Legal, Finance, Sales, Ops' asserts a progression that does not exist. Use `bar`, or `stacked-bar` if each one decomposes.

## A filled area for several series

Two opaque regions hide each other. Use `stacked-area` when the series sum to a total; the kernel drops the fill rather than lie.

# When NOT to reach for line.

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## **A trend where the story is attainment against a target**

If the question is 'did we hit the number', the target is not on the line. `bullet` puts actual, target and a band on one row.

# See also.

`bar` — the categories are unordered and the claim is magnitude, not movement

`slope` — there are exactly two points and the story is which entities changed rank

`stacked-bar` — each period decomposes into parts and the periods are compared, not connected

`bullet` — the number is read against a target and a qualitative band, not against its own past

`gantt` — the horizontal axis is real dates carrying durations rather than an ordered set of measurements